

Terms of Reference for Eritrea NDA Secretariat

A. Purpose of the TOR

1. The National Designated Authority (**NDA**) serves as the official interface between the Government of Eritrea and the Green Climate Fund (**GCF** or **the Fund**). The NDA provides broad strategic oversight of the GCF's activities in the country and communicates the country's priorities for financing low-emission and climate-resilient development. The GCF Governing Instrument describes the principal role of recipient countries' NDAs when engaging with GCF as follows:

"46. Recipient countries may designate a national authority. This national designated authority will recommend to the Board funding proposals in the context of national climate strategies and plans, including through consultation processes."

2. In addition to matters related to funding proposals, GCF engages with NDAs on other matters such as on nomination of direct access accredited entities, readiness proposals and country programming. NDAs act as the Focal Point for GCF's communication with the countries.
3. In Eritrea, the NDA to GCF is the Ministry of Land, Water, and Environment (**MoLWE**) represented by the Minister and GCF/UNFCCC Focal Point.
4. To engage effectively and efficiently with GCF, the NDA will be supported by a permanent Secretariat housed at MoLWE comprising technical, policy, and administrative personnel. The Secretariat ensures transparent decision-making and endorsement processes, upholds national ownership of all GCF-financed projects and readiness support, maintains coherence with national climate change priorities and development goals, and carries out the day-to-day functions of the NDA as the bridge between CGF and national stakeholders.
5. This Terms of Reference (**ToR**) sets out the mandate, functions, institutional arrangements and operating procedures of the Eritrea NDA and its dedicated Secretariat. This ToR is guided by:
 - (a) GCF Board decisions on **country ownership** and NDAs/focal points, including decisions B.04/05, B.06/10, B.10/10, B.11/10 and B.17/21, and subsequent updates to the no-objection procedure (B.41/02).
 - (b) GCF **initial best-practice guidelines for the selection and establishment of NDAs/focal points and best-practice options for coordination and multi-stakeholder engagement** (decision B.08/10).
 - (c) Eritrea's existing and emerging climate policy framework, including its NDC, national adaptation and resilience strategies, sectoral climate plans and long-term development vision.
6. GCF's *"Initial best-practice guidelines for the selection and establishment of national designated authorities and focal points"*¹ recommends the NDA to have the following capacities:
 - (a) *Adequate knowledge of national priorities, strategies, and plans;*
 - (b) *The ability to contribute to and drive national development strategies and plans;*
 - (c) *Familiarity with both mitigation and adaptation efforts and needs in the country;*

¹ GCF Board decision B.08/10

- (d) *Familiarity with relevant institutions and stakeholders in the countries (including contacts with multilateral and bilateral institutions, civil society organizations, and sub-national, national or regional entities that may be potential candidates for accreditation as intermediaries or implementing entities);*
- (e) *Capacity to facilitate and coordinate country coordination mechanisms and multi-stakeholder engagement for country consultations;*
- (f) *The ability to monitor and evaluate in accordance with relevant guidelines of the Fund; and*
- (g) *An overview of activities of other relevant multilateral, bilateral, regional and global funding mechanisms and institutions working in the country.*

B. Objective of the NDA

7. The NDA Secretariat has been established to handle the day-to-day work of the NDA. Its objective is **to provide coordinated and technically sound support to the NDA in performing its responsibilities under the GCF framework**. This includes ensuring that all GCF proposals are consistent with Eritrea's climate strategies, supporting national entities in accessing climate finance, strengthening the country's access to climate finance and capacity building and maintaining effective communication between the NDA, GCF Secretariat, and domestic stakeholders.

C. Core Responsibilities of the NDA

8. The core roles and responsibilities of the NDA include the following are:

8.1 Proposal Review and Quality Assurance:

- (a) Manage the NDA multi-stage review process of concept notes, project-preparation facility (PPF) requests, and funding proposals to ensure that these proposals align with Eritrea's climate priorities and strategies, and there is complimentary and coherence across activities funded by other climate funds and actors in Eritrea as set in Eritrea's NOL.
- (b) Coordinate with national technical units to evaluate the climate rationale, feasibility, cost efficiency, ESS compliance, and gender integration of proposals.

8.2 Strategic Oversight:

- a) Ensure alignment of funding proposals with national sustainable development and climate objectives, frameworks, strategies and policies.
- b) Ensure strategic oversight of the implementation of GCF-funded projects and programmes.

8.3 National No-Objection Procedure (NOP) Management:

- (a) The NDA shall establish and oversee a transparent, written national NOP that is consistent with GCF Board decision B.08/10 and subsequent modifications under decision B.41/02.
- (b) As per "Eritrea's Guidelines for the No Objection Procedure," lead the NOP workflow, including stakeholder consultation, circulation of documents, compilation of comments, consolidation of technical assessments, and issuance of No-Objection Letters (NOLs) and Letter of Supports (LOS), as applicable.
- (c) Ensure that timelines and procedural requirements are adhered to, with clear documentation at each step under the NOP.
- (d) Update the NOP if required by significant changes in relevant GCF policies or national institutional reforms.

8.4 Accreditation - Nominate entities for Direct access:

- Identify and support **national and sub-regional institutions** with potential for GCF accreditation for direct access (**Direct Access Entity** or **DAE**) based on national climate priorities and strategies.
- Manage the nomination process for new DAEs and support their reaccreditation processes, issuing nomination letters to entities for direct access accreditation to the Fund, selected in line with the national strategic priorities.
- Facilitate capacity assessments and institutional strengthening for national entities seeking accreditation, including through readiness proposals aimed at strengthening AEs.

8.5 Country Programming and Pipeline Development

- (a) Lead the development and periodic updating of the GCF country programme, presenting Eritrea's climate change priorities with the GCF and outlining and prioritizing a pipeline of transformational investment opportunities across key sectors (e.g. water, agriculture, energy, coastal zones, urban resilience), aligned with Eritrea's Nationally Determined Contributions (**NDC**), nationally appropriate mitigation actions (**NAMAs**) and national adaptation plans (**NAPs**) for potential funding. The country programme will ensure complementarity and coherences with potential interventions and planned projects by other climate funds and development funders operating in Eritrea.

What is a GCF Country Programme?

A GCF Country Programme is the **official national strategy** that guides how a country works with GCF. It is:

- **Government-led**, approved by the NDA.
- **Strategic**, identifying transformative investment priorities in mitigation and adaptation.
- **A planning instrument**, used to structure national engagement with GCF pipelines, readiness, PPF requests, and long-term partnership with accredited entities.
- **A living document**, updated periodically as national priorities evolve.

Together with the NOP, the Country Programme is the core instrument of country ownership.

- (b) Maintain and regularly update a GCF project/programme pipeline, indicating readiness and PPF, concept and funding proposal stages, with clear prioritisation criteria.
- (c) Convene all relevant national and sub-national public, private, and civil society stakeholders to prepare the Country Programme and support engagement with the GCF or other climate finance matters requiring national consultation.
- (d) Announce calls for project ideas and Concept Notes to generate the national project pipeline in line with the approved schedule for programme updates.
- (e) Ensure the engagement of stakeholders representing women and children, and other vulnerable and disadvantaged groups in the design and/or implementation.

8.6 Institutional Strengthening and Readiness

- (a) Identify and prioritize areas where capacity-building and readiness support are needed and request readiness support under GCF's Readiness and Preparatory Support Programme (**Readiness Programme**) targeting, but not limited to:

- NDA strengthening and strategic frameworks
- Country programming and pipeline development
- Institutional capacity building for potential DAEs

- (b) Implement readiness projects and capacity-building initiatives funded by GCF Readiness Programme.
- (c) Support national stakeholders in enhancing institutional capacity and procedures for accessing climate finance efficiently and transparently.

8.7 Communication and Coordination, and Stakeholder engagement

- (a) Serve as the central liaison with the GCF Board and GCF Secretariat.
- (b) Coordinate information sharing with ministries, institutions, private sector partners, civil society, and development partners.
- (c) Organize national consultations and awareness-raising on GCF opportunities and guidelines.

8.8 Monitoring, Reporting, and Oversight

- (a) Maintain a database of GCF portfolio activities within Eritrea, including funding proposal pipeline, approved projects, readiness grants, and PPF grants, and track their implementation status.
- (b) Maintain a database of national consultations, and stakeholder engagements.
- (c) Lead an annual participatory review of the GCF portfolio in Eritrea, monitor project performance and report to the GCF and national authorities.

9. These responsibilities are delegated operationally to the NDA Secretariat. These terms of reference have been formulated to ensure that the NDA Secretariat's personnel are able to cover all of these responsibilities. In certain instances, specific technical tasks, such as assessing compliance with GCF environmental and social safeguards, gender policy, financial policies, and other Board-approved operational requirements, may be delegated to existing offices within the Ministry of Land, Water and Environment that possess the needed technical expertise to avoid redundancy in human resources. Where specialized technical activities cannot be completed solely by the NDA Secretariat, these may be outsourced to qualified, independent experts, including for training, capacity development, independent technical assessments, or other specialized technical advice, ensuring robust and compliant oversight of GCF-financed projects and readiness activities.

D. Composition of NDA Secretariat and Terms of References

10. The NDA Secretariat will be housed at and administratively integrated to **MoLWE**. The NDA Secretariat comprises the following personnel:

- i. NDA Director (Head of Unit)
- ii. GCF Coordinator (communication appointee)
- iii. Technical Officer
- iv. Technical Assistant
- v. Information Technology Specialist

NDA Secretariat personnel will be seconded from existing staff within the MoLWE and will therefore remain subject to MoLWE's established human resource management policies and procedures. Staff will be appointed by the NDA Director (Head of Unit) for an open-ended term, the duration of which will be determined at the discretion of the NDA Director.

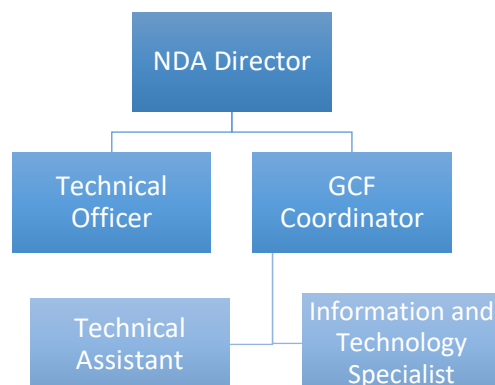


Figure 1: NDA Organigram

D.1. NDA Director (Head of Unit)

Mandate: The NDA Director provides strategic, technical, and operational leadership to the NDA Secretariat, overseeing Eritrea’s engagement with GCF. The NDA Director ensures that all GCF-related processes are transparent, efficient, compliant with national laws and regulations as well as GCF requirements, and aligned with national climate and development priorities.

Key Responsibilities:

1. Strategic Leadership & Planning

- Lead the planning, coordination, and oversight of all NDA Secretariat activities.
- Oversee the development and execution of annual work plans, readiness projects, and implementation schedules.
- Provide strategic guidance to ensure coherent national engagement with the GCF across sectors and institutions.
- Manage and coordinate the work of Secretariat personnel and consultants to ensure effective delivery.
- Provide strategic oversight of monitoring, reporting, and performance of all NDA Secretariat functions.

2. Oversight of GCF Proposal Review & No-Objection Procedure

- Supervise the review and endorsement of concept notes (CNs), Project Preparation Facility (PPF) requests, and full funding proposals (FPs) to be submitted to the GCF, ensuring alignment of all proposals with national climate strategies, the NDC, NAP, sectoral plans, and national development priorities.
- Appraise and endorse CNs and FPs in a fair, objective, and transparent manner using established criteria and decision-making tools—including multi-criteria assessments and cost-benefit analysis—within the no-objection procedure and based on the national appraisal template.

- Approve No-Objection Letters (NOLs) following completion of internal review and consultations.
- Ensure that quality assurance processes are applied consistently and documented.

3. Leadership on Readiness & Preparatory Support

- Provide leadership on the deployment of readiness and preparatory support funding in the country, including identifying and selecting suitable delivery partners (international, regional, national, or subnational public, private, or non-governmental institutions).
- Guide and oversee the implementation of readiness grants, ensuring timely execution, strong coordination, and full alignment with national climate and development priorities.
- Coordinate the review of Readiness Proposals, ensuring that proposed readiness activities contribute to institutional strengthening, pipeline development, and enhanced national access to climate finance.
- Oversee the tracking, monitoring, and reporting of readiness grants, including addressing implementation bottlenecks.

4. Accreditation, AE Nominations & AE Partnership Strategy

- Lead the assessment and prioritization of national entities for GCF accreditation under the direct access or international access modalities.
- Develop, maintain, and oversee implementation of a national accreditation strategy to guide long-term engagement with candidate Direct Access Entities (DAEs).
- Engage with potential entities seeking GCF accreditation.
- Issue NDA nomination letters for DAE applicants, ensuring compliance with GCF accreditation requirements and alignment with national climate finance priorities.
- Oversee accreditation readiness support, including institutional capacity assessments and accreditation gap analyses.
- Maintain regular communication with existing Accredited Entities (AEs) operating nationally to ensure alignment with national priorities and pipeline needs.
- Act as a national liaison between domestic stakeholders seeking to develop projects and potential AEs, facilitating matchmaking when proponents require an accredited partner.
- Organize bilateral AE engagement sessions, national AE dialogues, and pipeline matchmaking workshops.
- Provide AEs with up-to-date information on national priorities, sectoral investment areas, readiness results, and project pipeline direction.

5. Stakeholder Coordination & Pipeline Development

- Lead national, sectoral, and subnational consultations to support project origination and pipeline development.
- Oversee coordination with ministries, national institutions, private sector actors, civil society organizations, academia, and development partners to strengthen country ownership of GCF-funded initiatives, Ensuring meaningful and inclusive engagement, following national and GCF guidelines for stakeholder participation.

6. Representation & External Engagement

- Represent the NDA in engagements with the GCF Secretariat, GCF Board, Accredited Entities, Delivery Partners, and regional and international climate finance forums.

- Communicate national priorities and strategic directions to international partners to strengthen Eritrea's visibility and positioning in climate finance dialogues.

7. Reporting, Monitoring & Accountability

- Oversee annual reporting to the GCF and the Ministry of Land, Water and Environment, ensuring compliance with GCF monitoring and reporting requirements for readiness grants, project pipelines, and accreditation processes.
- Validate inception reports, annual progress reports, completion reports, and other deliverables before submission to the GCF or Delivery Partners.
- Oversee documentation, archiving, and transparency of all NDA processes.

8. Team Management & Supervision

- Supervise all NDA Secretariat personnel and consultants, ensuring clarity of roles and coordinated delivery.
- Conduct annual performance reviews and support capacity development of Secretariat staff.
- Foster a collaborative, accountable, and high-performance working environment within the Secretariat.

D.2 GCF Coordinator (Communication Appointee)

Mandate: The GCF Coordinator serves as the official liaison between the Government of Eritrea and the Green Climate Fund (GCF). The role ensures timely, accurate, and transparent flow of information between the NDA Secretariat, national stakeholders, Accredited Entities (AEs), Delivery Partners, and the GCF Secretariat. The GCF Coordinator supports communication, documentation, coordination, and procedural compliance across all GCF-related activities.

Key Responsibilities:

1. Official Communication & Correspondence Management

- Serve as the formal communication channel between the NDA and the GCF Secretariat for all notifications, submissions, clarifications, and official exchanges, ensuring timely acknowledgement and response to GCF communications, adhering to required deadlines and protocols.
- Prepare, format, and transmit official documents including No-Objection Letters, endorsement letters, progress reports, and nomination letters, ensuring all submissions follow the required GCF templates, guidance notes, and procedural steps.

2. Information Dissemination & Stakeholder Outreach

- Disseminate GCF policies, guidance notes, templates, decisions, and procedural updates to all relevant national stakeholders.
- Inform stakeholders of calls for proposals, readiness opportunities, accreditation updates, and important deadlines.
- Prepare and circulate meeting invitations, consultation notifications, workshop materials, and briefing documents in a timely manner.
- Support the Secretariat in ensuring transparency by publicly disclosing approved proposals, NOLs, readiness results, and relevant updates.

3. Documentation, Records & Information Management

- Maintain a comprehensive archive of all correspondence with the GCF Secretariat, including submissions, clarifications, technical notes, and official responses, ensuring documentation is accessible to NDA Secretariat staff and complies with data security protocols.
- Track and file NDA submissions, NOLs, appraisal forms, concept notes, readiness documents, and AE nomination materials.
- Maintain updated communication logs, submission trackers, and version-controlled document repositories.

4. Support to Proposal Development & No-Objection Procedure

- Coordinate the circulation of draft concept notes (CNs), PPF applications, and full proposals (FPs) among relevant ministries and stakeholders for internal review.
- Track comments and inputs received during technical and stakeholder consultations, and consolidate summaries for the NDA Director.
- Manage communication flows related to the No-Objection Procedure (NOP), including timelines, disclosures, and transmission of NOLs.
- Assist project proponents and Accredited Entities by providing timely guidance on GCF templates, requirements, and submission procedures.

5. Accredited Entity Communication & Support

- Maintain regular communication with national, regional and international AEs involved in Eritrea's portfolio or pipeline.
- Provide AEs with up-to-date information on national priorities, pipeline status, stakeholder consultations, readiness progress, and NDA timelines.
- Arrange AE engagement meetings, bilateral AE–proponent dialogues, and matchmaking events.
- Track AE inquiries, follow-up requests, and action items, ensuring timely communication and documentation.

6. Stakeholder Coordination & Consultation Support

- Coordinate logistical and communication aspects of national consultations, workshops, and bilateral meetings related to pipeline development, readiness implementation, or accreditation.
- Maintain stakeholder contact lists, communication distribution lists, and consultation attendance records.
- Compile notes, summaries, and follow-up points from consultations and share them with the NDA Director and Technical Assistance staff.

7. Readiness & Reporting Support

- Assist in compiling information for readiness progress reports, including timelines, activity summaries, communication logs, and stakeholder engagement records.
- Coordinate submission of readiness-related communications with Delivery Partners and GCF Secretariat.
- Track readiness inquiries from the GCF and Delivery Partners and ensure timely responses.

- Maintain readiness documentation archives and support the NDA Director in validating progress reports and completion reports.

8. Public Disclosure & Transparency

- Support implementation of the NDA's transparency policy by ensuring that public-facing documents (NOLs, project summaries, AE nomination announcements, readiness results) are published within required timelines.
- Work with the Information Technology Specialist to ensure that disclosures are shared.
- Maintain a disclosure register and ensure compliance with GCF information-sharing and dissemination standards.

9. Internal Coordination & Secretariat Support

- Participate in technical meetings within the NDA Secretariat, providing updates on communication flows and pending submissions.
- Notify Secretariat staff and technical reviewers of upcoming deadlines, new guidance materials, and proposal-related correspondence.
- Support quality control by verifying that outgoing communications meet GCF and government standards.
- Assist in the preparation of briefing notes, presentations, and talking points for the NDA Director.

D.3 Technical Officer

Mandate: The Technical Officer provides high-level policy, technical, and strategic guidance to ensure that all GCF-related activities are fully aligned with Eritrea's national climate strategies, sectoral priorities, and international commitments. The role coordinates technical assessments, supports cross-ministerial engagement, and ensures the integration of climate science, policy frameworks, and safeguards into all GCF engagements.

Key Responsibilities:

1. Technical and Policy Leadership

- Provide authoritative guidance on alignment of all GCF proposals with national climate strategies, including the NDC, NAP, sectoral policies, the National Development Plan, and other relevant frameworks.
- Lead the technical review of climate rationale, adaptation planning, mitigation analysis, and sectoral coherence in concept notes and funding proposals, Ensuring that proposals follow established technical quality standards and reflect current climate data, vulnerability assessments, and scientific evidence.
- Track policy and technical developments from GCF Board meetings, COP negotiations, IPCC assessments, and regional climate policy forums. Prepare briefings on relevant changes for senior officials and provide technical updates and presentations to NDA Secretariat staff when appropriate.
- Maintain an up-to-date knowledge base of climate policy developments, GCF policy changes, and international best practices.

2. Support to Proposal Review & Alignment Assessments

- Provide technical assessments of concept notes, PPF requests, and funding proposals, ensuring their alignment with national climate priorities, and that climate rationale, adaptation justification, mitigation pathways, and paradigm-shift potential are robust, evidence-based, and compliant with GCF investment criteria.
- Identify gaps or inconsistencies in proposals and provide guidance to project proponents and Accredited Entities on required improvements.

3. Oversight of Gender, ESS, and Cross-Cutting Integration

- Coordinate closely with the Environmental and Social Impact Review Unit to ensure safeguard reviews are conducted appropriately with support from the Technical Assistant.
- Review concept notes, and PPF requests for funding proposals for consistency with national gender policies, sectoral safeguards frameworks, and relevant environmental legislation.
- Oversee mainstreaming of cross-cutting issues such as climate resilience, biodiversity, ecosystem management, and community participation.

4. Coordination with Line Ministries and Technical Agencies

- Lead engagement with relevant ministries, institutions, and technical departments to ensure coordinated contributions to the GCF pipeline.
- Provide technical guidance on the formulation of project ideas, climate rationale, and alignment with national adaptation and mitigation priorities, sectoral plans, and GCF investment priorities.
- Facilitate sectoral working groups and expert technical committees as needed.

5. Support to Pipeline Development & Strategic Programming

- Provide strategic direction for the development of the national GCF pipeline, ensuring balance across sectors and alignment with climate and development priorities.
- Guide ministries and stakeholders in developing technically sound project ideas for inclusion in the pipeline, ensuring project concepts support long-term climate resilience, low-emissions development pathways, and national climate priorities.
- Contribute to updates of the Country Programme and national climate finance strategy.

6. Stakeholder Engagement & Consultation Support

- Provide technical content during national, sectoral, and subnational consultations related to project origination, pipeline development, and readiness implementation, ensuring that guidance provided during consultations reflects national policy frameworks and up-to-date climate science.
- Review consultation outcomes and ensure they inform proposal design and pipeline refinement.

7. Readiness, Accreditation & Capacity Strengthening Support

- Provide technical oversight for readiness projects that involve policy alignment, climate rationale development, NDC/NAP strengthening, or sectoral climate planning, ensuring readiness outputs reflect national priorities and support institutional capability development.
- Support accreditation assessments by reviewing institutional climate-relevance, technical capacity, and alignment with climate policy frameworks.

- Provide capacity-building sessions for ministries, institutions, and other stakeholders on climate policy, GCF technical requirements, and climate science.

8. Reporting, Knowledge Management & Internal Coordination

- Prepare technical inputs for inception reports, annual progress reports, completion reports, and ad hoc submissions to the GCF.
- Maintain a technical knowledge base of climate policy, sectoral data, and relevant research to support ongoing proposal development.
- Provide regular updates on climate policy trends, scientific developments, and GCF policy changes during Secretariat coordination meetings.
- Support the NDA Director with analytical briefs, technical memos, and strategic policy recommendations.

D.4 Technical Assistant (TA)

Purpose: The Technical Assistance (TA) position provides analytical, technical, and operational support to the NDA Secretariat across all GCF-related functions, including proposal review, pipeline development, accreditation support, readiness implementation, stakeholder engagement, and information management. The TA supports the technical strengthening of national institutions and ensures that GCF processes are implemented efficiently, transparently, and in line with national priorities.

Key Responsibilities:

- Assist in the development of project pipelines and concept formulation aligned with GCF investment criteria.
- Facilitate technical consultations with sectoral ministries, civil society, and private sector actors.
- Contribute to capacity-building activities and readiness initiatives supported by the GCF.
- With the help of the TA, maintain an up-to-date knowledge base of GCF policies, decisions, operational modalities, and guidance documents.

1. Technical Review & Proposal Assessment

- Conduct initial assessments of concept notes (CNs), Project Preparation Facility (PPF) requests, and full funding proposals (FPs).
- Prepare structured review notes covering climate rationale, feasibility, financial analysis, gender integration, ESS risk considerations, and alignment with GCF investment criteria.
- Support the NDA Director and Technical Officer in ensuring consistency with sectoral policies, NDC/NAP priorities, and national development plans.
- Maintain documentation and logs for all technical assessments conducted.

2. Support to No-Objection Procedure (NOP) & Proposal Workflow

- Manage the internal workflow for the No-Objection Procedure, ensuring that NOP requirements, disclosure steps, and appraisal tools are applied consistently, including tracking timelines, collecting comments, and consolidating review inputs from technical ministries and stakeholders.

- Support the National Climate Finance Steering Committee in the implementation of the NOP and Proposal Workflow
- Consolidate assessment sheets and technical briefing notes to support NDA approval processes.
- Support proponents and Accredited Entities by providing clarification on GCF requirements and the national appraisal process.

3. Pipeline Development & Project Origination Support

- Support identification and development of project ideas and concepts aligned with national climate priorities and GCF investment criteria.
- Assist ministries, national institutions, and other stakeholders in preparing initial project ideas, logic models, climate rationales, and draft concept notes.
- Maintain and update the national project pipeline register, including project status, timeline, sector, AE partnership, and readiness links.
- Provide inputs for pipeline development workshops and sector engagement sessions.
- Share project proposals with the Environmental and Social Impact Review Unit for review.

4. Readiness Programme Support

- Support the implementation of readiness grants, including tracking activities, documenting progress, and consolidating inputs for readiness reporting.
- Assist in preparing technical inputs for inception reports, annual progress reports, and completion reports.
- Support the NDA Director in monitoring readiness grant performance, identifying bottlenecks, and ensuring timely delivery of activities.
- Provide analytical and logistical support to readiness delivery partners, ministries, and implementing partners.

5. Accreditation Support & AE Nomination Assistance

- Assist candidate national entities seeking accreditation by explaining GCF accreditation requirements and documentation needs.
- Support accreditation gap assessments, including fiduciary, ESS, gender, and governance capacity reviews.
- Help prepare supporting materials for NDA nomination packages, including institutional questionnaires and evidence compilation.
- Maintain a database of potential Direct Access Entities (DAEs), their status, institutional capacity, and readiness needs.
- Provide technical inputs to the NDA Director on the accreditation strategy and prioritization of entities for accreditation support.

6. AE Engagement & Matchmaking Support

- Maintain a record of active regional and international Accredited Entities (AEs), including sector focus, accreditation category, and implementation history.
- Support the organization of AE matchmaking events, bilateral AE–proponent meetings, and pipeline alignment discussions.

- Provide project proponents with information on AE requirements and expectations to help structure project ideas according to AE criteria.
- Track AE follow-up actions, technical queries, and next steps in pipeline development.

7. Stakeholder Consultation & Engagement Support

- Provide technical, logistical, and administrative support for national, sectoral, and subnational consultations related to GCF pipeline development, proposal review, accreditation, or readiness implementation.
- Draft agendas, prepare presentations, collect feedback, and produce post-consultation summaries.
- Maintain gender-disaggregated attendance lists, follow-up action matrices, and consultation documentation.
- Assist with preparation of technical materials for workshops, dialogues, and bilateral meetings.

8. Knowledge Management, Tracking & Technical Monitoring

- Maintain up-to-date logs tracking proposal development, NOP workflow, readiness activities, AE engagement, and accreditation progress.
- Monitor developments in GCF guidance, technical standards, and operational requirements, and provide concise updates to NDA staff (e.g., changes in templates, new readiness opportunities, updated investment criteria).
- Support the Technical Officer in keeping technical and policy knowledge bases updated with relevant climate data, research, and GCF guidance.
- Ensure that all technical documents, assessments, and versions are organized, stored, and accessible through the NDA's information management systems.

9. Internal Coordination & Secretariat Support

- Participate in NDA Secretariat coordination meetings and provide updates on technical workflows, proposal status, and ongoing consultations.
- Prepare briefing notes, analytical summaries, and technical memos for the NDA Director and Technical Officer.
- Support inter-ministerial coordination by summarizing sector-based inputs and ensuring information flows efficiently within the Secretariat.
- Assist in preparing presentations, talking points, dashboards, and monitoring tools to support NDA decision-making.

D.5 Information Technology Specialist

Purpose: To provide technical and operational support for the NDA Secretariat's IT systems, ensuring effective digital infrastructure, data management, and information security to support the NDA's climate finance functions.

Key Responsibilities:

- **IT Infrastructure & Hardware Management**

- Maintain and manage the NDA Secretariat's IT infrastructure, including servers, networks, user devices, and all IT hardware, ensuring reliable and secure access to all IT systems for NDA staff.
- Oversee procurement, setup, configuration, maintenance, and inventory of IT equipment.
- **System Administration & Support**
 - Deliver technical assistance to NDA staff, troubleshooting hardware and software issues.
 - Support virtual communications and coordination with the GCF Secretariat, including online submissions.
 - Maintain and update digital tools used for project management, reporting, and stakeholder engagement.
 - Provide **on-site support during workshops, trainings, and events**, ensuring smooth operation of IT systems and equipment.
 - Coordinate with external vendors and service providers for system maintenance or upgrades.
- **Knowledge Management & Data Systems**
 - Maintain databases and digital repositories for NDA-related documents, project information, and correspondence.
 - Track developments in climate finance digital tools, GCF IT platforms, COP-related reporting systems, and other relevant IT resources.
- **Capacity Building & IT Guidance**
 - Provide training to NDA staff on IT tools, platforms, and digital best practices.
 - Develop user manuals, SOPs, and guidance notes for effective use of NDA IT systems.
 - Support knowledge transfer and ensure continuity of IT functions within the Secretariat.
- **Coordination & Liaison**
 - Liaise with relevant national and international entities on IT-related matters, including GCF digital systems, reporting portals, and climate finance tracking tools.
 - Participate in relevant technical meetings and workshops to stay updated on IT developments in climate finance and digital governance.

E. Reporting and Coordination

All members of the NDA Secretariat report directly to the NDA Director (Head of Unit). The GCF Coordinaator serves as the formal communication channel between the NDA Secretariat and the GCF Secretariat, while the Technical Officer provides strategic and technical oversight.

The Technical Assistance and Information Technology Specialist staff support the daily operational and analytical needs of the Secretariat.

Regular coordination meetings will be convened by the NDA Director to review progress, address challenges, and ensure timely delivery of outputs in line with national and GCF requirements.

F. Monitoring, Review and Amendment of this ToR

1. The NDA, supported by the NDA Secretariat, shall review the **effectiveness of these arrangements** and these ToR at least every three years, or earlier if required by significant changes in GCF policies or national institutional reforms.

2. Amendments to this ToR require **approval by the Government of Eritrea** at the appropriate level and notification to the GCF Secretariat where relevant.

Eritrea NDA Performance Indicators

NDA Responsibility Area	Performance Indicators (PI)
1. Proposal Review and Quality Assurance	PI-1.1 100% of concept notes (CNs), PPF requests, and funding proposals reviewed within agreed timelines. PI-1.2 ≥90% of proposals meet GCF technical and fiduciary standards before submission.
2. Strategic Oversight	PI-2.1. 100% alignment of GCF-funded projects with national climate and development priorities, NDC, NAMA and NAP.
3. National No-Objection Procedure (NOP) Management	PI3.1. National NOP is reviewed and updated every 3 years, or as required by policy changes or changes in national institutional framework. PI- 3.2. 90% of NOP workflows completed on schedule, including consultation, document circulation, and consolidation of feedback. PI-3.3. Decisions on No-Objection Letters (NOLs) and Letter of Support (LOS) are made within agreed timelines after internal review.
4. Accreditation - Nominate entities for Direct access	PI-4.1. At least 2 national or sub-regional entities are nominated for direct access by 2027. PI-4.2. 1 national entity is accredited to GCF by Q2 of 2027 AE nominations, accreditation support, and matchmaking events conducted as planned, with ≥95% of deadlines met.
5. Country Programme & Pipeline Development	PI-5.1. – Eritrea Country Programme is developed and submitted to GCF by 2027 PI-5.2. ≥80% of proposed projects in the pipeline that align with Country Programme priorities. - Stakeholders (public, private, civil society) actively engaged in ≥90% of pipeline development consultations.
6. Institutional Strengthening & Readiness	PI-6.1. # of readiness proposals approved by GCF per year. - Capacity-building initiatives completed for ≥90% of targeted national stakeholders. - Institutional systems for accessing climate finance strengthened, evidenced by functional procedures, trained staff, and updated guidelines.
7. Stakeholder Engagement & Inclusivity	PI-7.1. At least 1 of structured stakeholder dialogues held annually. -List of stakeholders for engagement and consultations is reviewed and updated quarterly. - Participation of women, children, Indigenous Peoples, and other vulnerable groups documented in ≥80% of consultations. - Awareness-raising sessions on GCF and climate finance held at least twice per year.
8. Communication and Coordination	- All project, readiness, and correspondence records stored in digital repositories and updated at least monthly. - Quarterly progress reports prepared and submitted to the Ministry and GCF Secretariat on time. - Lessons learned, technical notes, and briefings generated for ≥90% of major activities.

	-100% of scheduled national consultations, stakeholder meetings, and awareness-raising events organized successfully with all relevant materials and IT support. -All GCF communications with the Secretariat, Board, and technical units acknowledged and responded to within required timelines. - ≥90% of ministries, institutions, private sector, civil society, and development partners actively engaged in consultations and coordination activities. -All communication outputs (briefing notes, presentations, reports, updates) submitted on time and comply with national and GCF standards.
9. Monitoring, Reporting, and Oversight	PI.9.1. At least 1 project monitoring field visit conducted per year. PI.9.2. -≥95% of project performance reports submitted to the GCF Secretariat and national authorities on time.

